



Open Source Productivity Tools that Run on Windows

The open source vs proprietary software debate will go on endlessly as each has its loyal proponents. However, open source clearly has the edge because of its wide acceptance by enterprises. Windows users can find useful open source tools to improve not just their productivity but also their overall computing experience.

The term 'open source' in the software context alludes to code that people can change and share because its design is publicly accessible. This term evolved over the course of the evolution of software to represent a particular approach to creating computer programs. Nowadays, the term 'open source' refers to a wider set of values that we call the 'open source way'.

Open source tasks, products and enterprises observe rules of open exchange, cooperative involvement, fast modelling, opacity, social organisation, and community-oriented processes. Whether a program is open source or not may not always be a big deal for developers, but it impacts users. In short, open source software permits and gives users' freedoms they would not otherwise have.

The idea behind open source

Let's suppose a program is open source and its source code is freely accessible to its users. Then, its users or anyone else have the power to change it as they wish to meet their requirements, and then make available the users' new variants of the program. People also have the power to make available or distribute as many transcripts of the fresh program as they want to. Anyone can use the program for any purpose; there are no licence fees or other limitations to the use of the software.

Ubuntu Linux is a well known open source operating platform. Users can download it, make as many transcripts of it as they wish and supply these to anyone. People can even install Ubuntu on an unlimited number of machines. You can even make an Ubuntu installation disk and freely distribute it.

The difference between open source software (OSS) and the other types

There is software that only the individuals or team units that created it, or the administration that currently has unshared control over it, can change. This type is called proprietary or closed source software. In order to make use of this proprietary software, computer users must accept that they will not do anything with the software that is not allowed by the author or owners of the software. Examples of such software are Microsoft Office, Adobe Photoshop, Corel Draw, etc.

The licence of open source software impacts the way people can use, work, alter, and distribute it. In general, open source licences permit you to use open source software

for any purpose you wish. There are some open source licences that people refer to as copyleft licences. These specify that anyone who releases an altered open source program necessarily has to also release, on board, the source code for that program.

Why open source is ahead of proprietary software

People generally choose open source software over proprietary software for a variety of reasons, as listed below.

1. **Control:** People opt for open source software because they have more power over such software. They can analyse the code to be sure that it's not doing anything they don't want it to do, and can alter it if they don't like it. Non-programmers can also profit from open source software because they can use this software for any purpose.
2. **Training:** People like open source software as it helps them to become good programmers. Since it is publicly available, they can study it well in order to learn to make finer software. They can even share their code with others, as their skills evolve.
3. **Security:** Open source software is safer and steadier than licensed software. Since anyone can view and alter open source software, somebody might point out and correct faults or mistakes that a program's original maker might have missed. Also, since many programmers can work on any part of open source software without asking for approval from the original authors, they can correct, modify, and improve open source software more quickly than licensed software.
4. **Stability:** People opt for open source software rather than licensed software for essential and long-term projects. As programmers publicly distribute code for open source software, individuals having faith in that software for difficult computing tasks can be certain that these open source tools won't vanish if their original creators stop working on them.

Open source for productivity

The big question is: what exactly do we need the software for? Though computing has transformed over the years, with the Web browser most likely becoming an essential productivity tool, definite constraints remain. So when evaluating open source software, remember, it must have written documentation, it must be capable of making/